

TURNING EVENT INTENT INTO AVAILABLE OUTFITS.

RetailNext customers are not just searching for products; they are shopping for moments. This briefing shows how OpenAI can interpret that intent while RetailNext keeps product, inventory, price, and fulfilment decisions grounded in its own systems.

CUSTOMER

event-ready outfits with store availability shown before the visit

ASSOCIATE

clear handoff notes, item rationale, and substitution paths

BUSINESS

visibility into missed demand, low stock, and failed missions

RETAILNEXT IS LOSING HIGH-INTENT SHOPPERS WHEN STYLE DISCOVERY AND LOCAL AVAILABILITY ARE DISCONNECTED.

The discovery signal is specific: shoppers are leaving poor reviews because they cannot find updated styles or specific items in stores for upcoming events. That is a conversion problem, a store execution problem, and a customer trust problem.

CUSTOMER SIGNAL "I know the event, not the SKU." Customers describe intent: a wedding guest look, a first-day outfit, a last-minute party, or something current in store.	FRICTION POINT Search and inventory answer separately. A relevant recommendation still fails if the item is unavailable locally, not event-appropriate, or impossible to complete as a basket.	BUSINESS IMPACT Failed missions become poor reviews. High-urgency shopping journeys create lower tolerance for friction, more associate lookup time, and less visibility into missed demand.
LOST CONVERSION high-intent shoppers abandon when availability confidence is low	MANUAL LOOKUP associates bridge style, stock, substitutes, and customer messaging	BRAND TRUST review pain scales when store discovery does not match digital promise

PEOPLE SHOP WITH INTENTION, BUT TRADITIONAL SEARCH STILL BEHAVES LIKE A KEYWORD MATCHER.

Event-based shopping carries context that keyword search misses: formality, weather, season, colour harmony, budget, urgency, and whether the shopper can actually find the look in a local store today.

TRADITIONAL SEARCH

BLACK DRESS

Returns product matches, then forces the shopper or associate to work out event fit, complementary items, substitutes, and availability.

INTENT-LED SHOPPING

SMART OUTFIT FOR A WINTER WEDDING IN NEW YORK

Understands the mission, retrieves semantically relevant products, checks store stock, and explains a complete outfit.

STRATEGIC SHIFT

The opportunity is not another chatbot. It is an intent-to-inventory layer that turns natural language and images into governed, measurable retail actions.

RETAILNEXT EVENT STYLIST CONNECTS INTENT, CATALOGUE RETRIEVAL, INVENTORY GROUNDING, AND ACTIVATION.

The prototype extends the OpenAI clothing RAG cookbook into an event-aware, inventory-aware stylist. OpenAI handles ambiguous judgement; RetailNext systems decide what is eligible, available, affordable, and safe to show.

UNDERSTAND Interpret item image, event, style, budget, store, and urgency	RETRIEVE Use embeddings to find catalogue candidates by meaning, not keywords alone	GROUND Apply SKU truth: inventory, price, role, budget, fulfilment, and substitutes	ACTIVATE Render basket, preview chat changes, brief associates, and trigger lifecycle follow-up
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WHAT OPENAI DOES

Converts ambiguity into usable retail intent.

Vision analysis, structured outputs, semantic search queries, chat-to-action reasoning, shopper explanations, and guardrail review.

WHAT RETAILNEXT CONTROLS

Owns the commercial truth.

Only catalogue SKUs are recommended. Price, stock, budget, fulfilment, substitutions, basket mutation, and CRM delivery stay deterministic.

THE LIVE APP MAKES THE BUSINESS CASE VISIBLE IN ONE SHOPPER JOURNEY.

The demo starts from a selected or uploaded starter item, builds a complete outfit for an event, then shows the same session becoming a basket, a store handoff, and a demand signal.



CUSTOMER

From starter item to complete look

The shopper sees fit scores, item rationale, price, and local stock before travelling to a store.



ASSOCIATE

From guesswork to guided handoff

Mira summarises why the outfit works, which items are low stock, and what substitutes protect the basket.



BUSINESS

From complaint to operating signal

Unmet event intent and stock gaps become inputs for allocation, buying, clienteling, and recovery workflows.

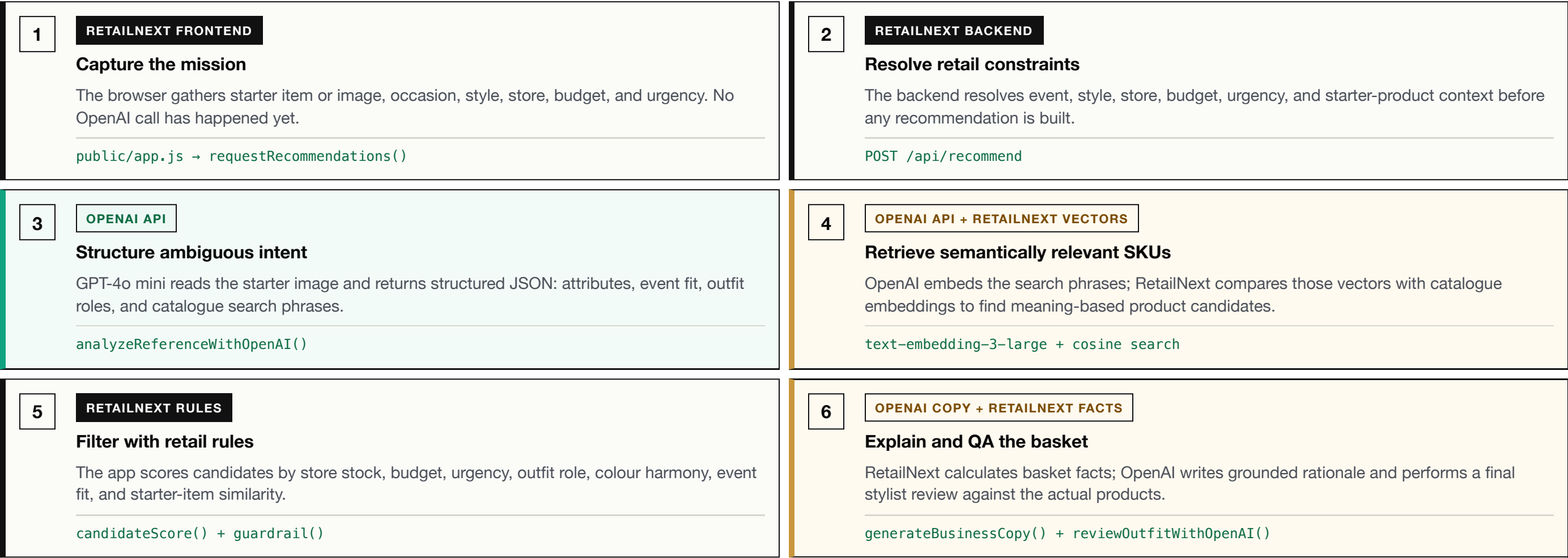
WHEN THE CUSTOMER CLICKS GENERATE OUTFIT, OPENAI PROPOSES AND RETAILNEXT VERIFIES.

The core architecture separates model judgement from retail authority: OpenAI interprets intent and language; the app enforces SKU, price, stock, budget, and fulfilment truth.

RETAILNEXT OWNED

OPENAI API

OPENAI + RETAILNEXT



Render only grounded outputs

The customer sees products, availability, rationale, Mira chat, and add-to-basket prompts based on the server-validated response.

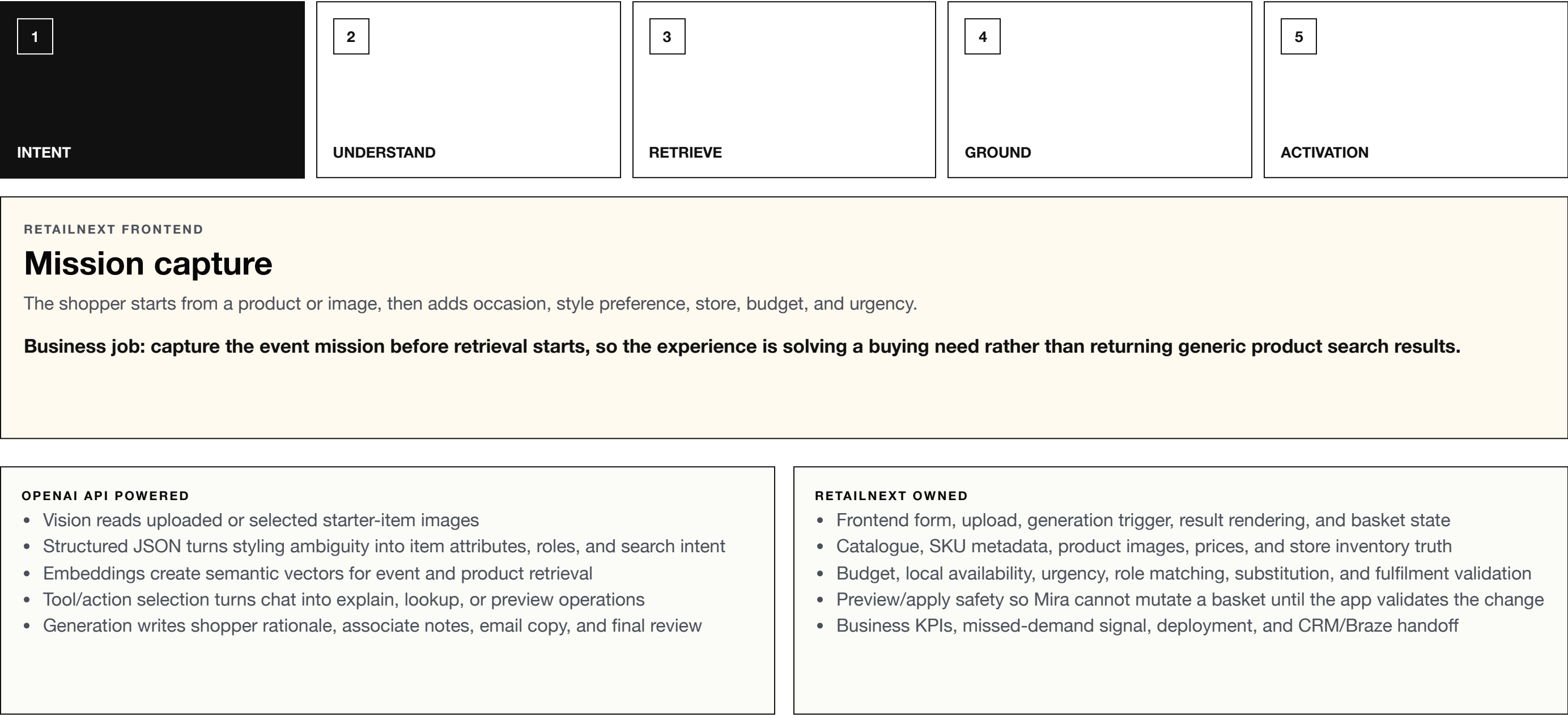
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renderResult()
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IMPORTANT BOUNDARY

OpenAI proposes interpretation, retrieval intent, rationale, and language. RetailNext owns catalogue data, SKU eligibility, price, inventory, fulfilment rules, basket state, and what is ultimately shown.

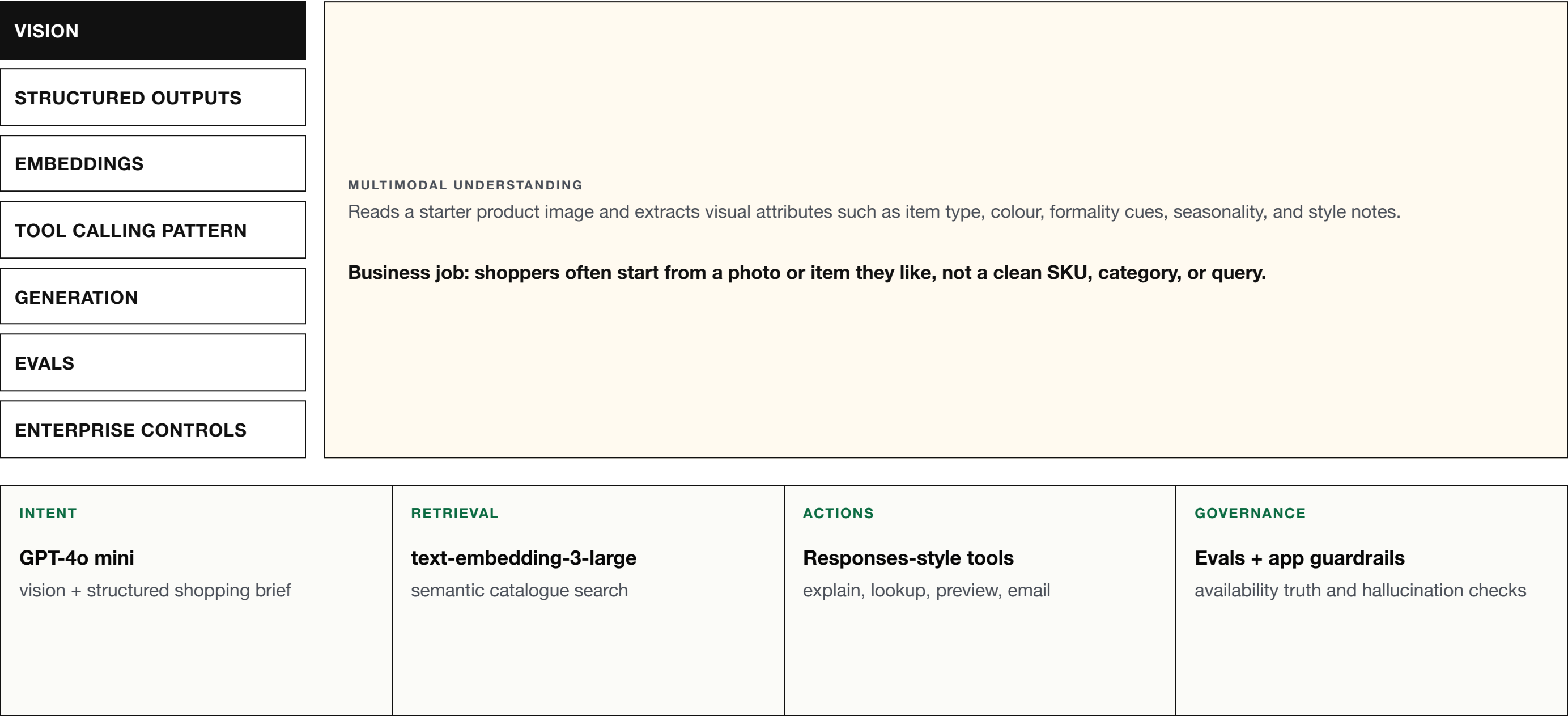
THE MODEL HANDLES JUDGEMENT; THE APPLICATION KEEPS AUTHORITY OVER RETAIL TRUTH.

Click through the flow to show which components are OpenAI-powered and which remain deterministic RetailNext controls.



OPENAI IS THE RIGHT FIT BECAUSE THIS PROBLEM NEEDS MORE THAN ONE MODEL CAPABILITY.

RetailNext needs multimodal understanding, semantic retrieval, structured integration, action safety, reliable generation, and an eval path in one platform.



THE VALUE IS FEWER FAILED MISSIONS, HIGHER BASKET CONFIDENCE, AND BETTER STORE EXECUTION.

Use the stakeholder toggle to frame the same solution for the Head of Innovation or CTO.

HEAD OF INNOVATION

CTO

HEAD OF INNOVATION LENS

This is an AI experience customers can feel: it turns event intent into a complete outfit, then extends the same session into associate support and CRM follow-up.

- Differentiates RetailNext from generic product search and static recommendation carousels.
- Creates a visible AI-assisted clienteling moment across digital and store channels.
- Turns poor-review root causes into measurable intervention points for merchandising and operations.

EXPERIENCE

Fewer dead-end missions

Customers see event fit and local availability before travelling to store.

REVENUE

Stronger event conversion

Complete outfits and substitutes protect attachment instead of recommending isolated SKUs.

OPERATIONS

Less manual lookup

Associates get the item list, rationale, inventory context, and backup options in one place.

PLANNING

Demand signal

Unmet event intent and stock gaps become inputs to transfer and replenishment decisions.

START NARROW, MEASURE MISSION COMPLETION, THEN SCALE INTO A REUSABLE RETAIL AI PLATFORM.

This production path keeps business proof and technical governance moving together.

30 DAYS

Crawl: validate demand

Pilot wedding guest, work event, and vacation journeys. Measure completed baskets, availability rate, refinement prompts, and feedback.

60 DAYS

Walk: integrate operations

Connect PIM, POS inventory, OMS fulfilment, preferences, Braze messaging, and associate workflows for selected stores.

90 DAYS

Run: harden and scale

Add evals for outfit coherence, substitution quality, availability truth, latency, cost, complaint rate, and conversion confidence.

CLOSING LINE

"The value is not AI styling in isolation. It is the connection between customer intent, in-store availability, and operational follow-through: OpenAI handles the ambiguity; RetailNext systems keep the recommendation grounded."